

UI Specification Document

Project: Personalized Trip Planner

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General Overview:

This web application is a personalized travel recommendation engine designed to simplify trip planning. Users provide specific inputs such as their budget, trip duration, and the number of travellers. The system processes this data on the server side to filter and return the most suitable travel destinations and itineraries from the database. The platform also fosters a community feel by allowing users to discuss trips in a dedicated forum.

This travel website includes six main pages:

1. **Login Page (/login)** – Allows users to enter their account and access the website.
2. **Signup Page (/finalize_signup)** – Allows new users to complete their registration by providing additional personal details.
3. **Trip Preferences Page (/preferences)** – A form where users answer questions about their travel needs and preferences, such as trip type, budget, number of travelers, and other details that help the website plan a suitable trip.
4. **Recommendations Page (/results)** – Displays a curated list of travel options that match the user's specific criteria, generated after server-side processing.
5. **Trip Details Page (/trip-details)** – Presents a specific destination in detail, including location, images, description, users' recommendations, and an option to chat with users about the destination.
6. **My Trips (/my-trips)** – A centralized gallery displaying all trips generated by the user to date, allowing them to revisit past itineraries, view saved trips, and track their travel history.

1. Login Page (/login)

Purpose – To allow registered users to log into their personal accounts.

Components:

- **Header:** Logo on the left, Navigation Menu on the right
-Menu on the right with links to Home, Preferences, and Contact Us.
- **Login Form (Centered):** The form is positioned in the centre of the page for optimal user focus.
- **Fields:**
 - Email Address (Required): A text field for the user's registered email
 - Password (Required): A masked text field for the user's password
 - Forgot Password Link: Located below the password field, redirecting users to the password recovery page.
 - Submit Button: Labeled "Login".

- **Behavior & Logic:**

Performs input validation and logs the user in.

- **Input Validation:** The application validates that the email format is correct and that the password field is not empty before submission.

- **Error Messages:** If authentication fails or fields are missing, an error message is displayed near the problematic field.

2. Signup Page (/finalize_signup)

Purpose: To allow new users to complete their registration by providing essential personal details and setting up their account security.

Components:

- **Header:** Logo on the left, Navigation Menu on the right
- **Finalization Form (Centered):** Progress Indicator: A small visual bar or text (e.g., "Step 2 of 2") indicating the user is at the final stage of registration.
- **Fields:**
 - First Name (required): Text input for the user's given name.
 - Last Name (required): Text input for the user's family name.
 - Password (required): Secure text input with validation for strength (e.g., minimum 8 characters).
 - Password Confirmation (required): Must match the password field to prevent typos.
- **Submit Button:** Labeled "Complete Registration."
- **Behavior & Logic:**
 - Performs input validation (matching passwords, required fields). Upon success, redirects the user to the Trip Preferences Page.

3. Trip Preferences Page (/preferences)

Purpose – The preferences page allows users to input their specific travel constraints and desires, providing the necessary data for the server-side processing to generate personalized recommendations

Components:

- **Header:** Logo on the left, Navigation Menu on the right
- **Preferences Form (Centered):**

Headline: A clear title such as "Design Your Trip".
- **Fields:**
 - Trip Type (Required): A dropdown menu to select the nature of the trip (e.g., Adventure, Romantic, Family, Urban)

- Budget (Required): A numeric input field or a slider to define the maximum budget in ILS.
- Duration (Required): A numeric field to enter the number of days for the trip.
- Number of Travelers (Required): A numeric input field.
- Specific Interests (Optional): A set of checkboxes for categories like "Nature," "Cuisine," "History," or "Nightlife".
- **Submit Button:** Labeled "Generate Recommendations".
- **Behavior & Logic:**
 - Input Validation: The form checks that all required fields are filled and that numbers (budget, days) are valid positive integers before submission.
 - Processing State: Upon submission, the button will show a loading spinner while the server processes the data and redirects the user to the Results page

4. Recommendations Page (/recommendations)

Purpose: This page displays a curated list of travel options generated by the server-side processing of the user's initial preferences. It serves as the primary results interface where users can view and further filter destinations that match their specific lifestyle and constraints.

Components:

- **Header:** Logo on the left, Navigation Menu on the right
- **Advanced Filter Sidebar:** Allows for real-time refinement of the results based on:
 - **Trip Style:** Categories such as Nature, Urban, Attractions, or Extreme sports.
 - **Dietary Requirements:** A dedicated toggle for "Kosher Food" availability.
 - **Budget & Group Size:** Sliders or input fields to update the search parameters.
- **Results Grid:** A responsive display of "Trip Cards". Each card contains:
 - **Clickable Image:** A high-quality photo representing the destination. Clicking the image automatically redirects the user to the "Trip Details & Forum" page for that specific trip.
 - **Trip Summary:** Destination title, category tags (e.g., "Urban", "Kosher-friendly"), and estimated price.
 - **Save Button:** A heart icon that allows users to add the trip to their "My Saved Trips" list.

Behavior & Logic:

- **Navigation:** The entire image area acts as a link to the detailed view or forum, ensuring a smooth transition for the user.
- **Server-Side Processing:** When filters are adjusted, the client sends a request to the server, which queries the database to return only the trips that satisfy all selected criteria (Budget, Style, and Kosher status).

5. Trip Details & Forum Page (/trip-details)

Purpose: This page provides an in-depth view of a specific travel itinerary and serves as a social hub where users can view ratings, read reviews, and interact with the community. It also allows users to finalize their decision by saving the trip to their personal list.

Components:

- **Header:** Logo on the left, Navigation Menu on the right
- **Trip Overview & Actions:**
 - **Detailed Itinerary:** A day-by-day breakdown of activities and locations.
 - **Essential Info:** Displays the "Kosher-Friendly" status, total cost, and recommended group size.
 - **Save Button:** A prominent "Save to My Trips" button (Heart icon) that adds the current trip to the user's favorites.
 - **Visual Gallery:** High-quality images of the destination.
- **Rating & Forum Section:**
 - **Star Rating System:** Displays the average user rating (e.g., 4.5/5 stars) calculated by the server.
 - **Review Feed:** A list of comments and individual ratings posted by other travelers.
 - **Interaction Field:** A form for authenticated users to select a star rating (1-5) and write a text review.
 - **Submit Button:** Sends the rating and comment to the server for processing.

Behavior & Logic:

- **Server-Side Calculation:** When a user submits a new rating, the server updates the database and recalculates the average score for that trip.
- **State Management:** The "Save" button checks if the trip is already in the user's favorites and updates the UI accordingly (e.g., changing the heart color).
- **Dynamic Loading:** The page uses a unique ID to fetch specific trip details and its associated forum thread from the database.

6. My Trips Page (/my-trips)

Purpose- To provide a centralized gallery where users can easily access and revisit all their generated trips, organized from the most recent to the oldest.

Components:

- **Header:** Logo on the left, Navigation Menu on the right
- **Trips Gallery (Grid Layout):**

- **Sort Order:** Trips are automatically displayed in reverse chronological order (newest itineraries appear first) for quick accessibility.
- **Trip Cards:** A 3-column grid (on desktop) where each card represents a specific trip, containing:
 - **Destination Image:** A high-quality thumbnail representing the destination.
 - **Trip Overview:** The destination name, travel dates, and a summary of the trip's theme.
 - **View Details Button:** A primary button that redirects the user to the full itinerary for that specific trip.
- **Empty State:**
 - **Message:** If the user hasn't generated any trips yet, a placeholder message will be displayed: "You haven't planned any trips yet."
 - **Start Planning Button:** A "Start Planning" button that redirects the user to the Trip Preferences Page.

UI Behavior Specifications

- **Input Validation:** All forms validate required fields (e.g., email format) before submission.
- **Error Messages:** Displayed near problematic fields for incorrect or missing info.
- **Responsive Design:** The layout adjusts for desktop and mobile devices to ensure usability on all screens.
- **Animations and Interactions:** Hover effects for buttons and menu items; smooth scrolling for navigation.

Visual Design Notes

Impression: Innovation, Reliability, and Adventure.

Color Scheme:

- **Primary Color:** #2980B9 (Ocean Blue) – Evokes trust and travel.
- **Accent Color:** #27AE60 (Forest Green) – Represents nature and adventure.
- **Background:** #FDFEFE (White) – For a clean, modern look.

Typography:

- **Font family:** Open Sans, sans-serif.
- **Font sizes:** 16px for body text, 24px for section titles, 36px for hero messages.